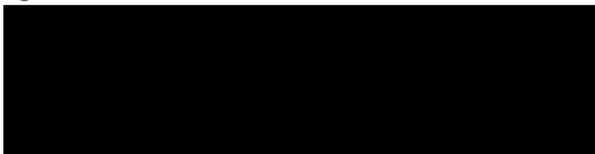

Department of the Air Force: Justification for Other Than Full and Open Competition

Dollar Value of this Acquisition: ☒ ≤ \$10M ☐ > \$10M and ≤ \$100M ☐ > \$100M and ≤ \$500M ☐ > \$500M

CERTIFICATIONS: CO certification serves as J&A approval ≤ \$10M, [See J&A Template Guidance](https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx#exceptions-to-full-and-open-competition-mandatory) at <https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx#exceptions-to-full-and-open-competition-mandatory> J&A Template Guidance tab

Date 23 April 2026	Contracting Officer (RFO 6.104-1(12)) Chris Stokes I certify that this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.	Signature 
Date 21 April 2026	Technical and Requirements Personnel (RFO 6.104(b)) Cael D. Fahnestock I certify that the supporting data herein, which is my responsibility, is accurate and complete.	Signature 

COORDINATION

APPROVALS (RFO 6.104-2(a) Table 6-1 & R-DFARS 206.104-72 Table 206.1)

See [J&A Template Guidance](https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx#exceptions-to-full-and-open-competition-mandatory) (<https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx#exceptions-to-full-and-open-competition-mandatory>) - Justification Approvals tab

NOTE 1: A signature block will appear here (replacing these notes) based on the "Dollar Value of this Acquisition" selected above. Since most digital signatures that include date/time-stamps are redacted before they are made publicly available, always insert the date in the "Date" cell when affixing a digital signature to this document.

Department of the Air Force: Justification for Other Than Full and Open Competition

I. Agency and Contracting Activity (RFO 6.104-1(a)(1)):

AFRL/PZLEQ
WPAFB, OH 45433-5309

II. Nature and/or description of the action being approved (RFO 6.104-1(a)(2)):

AFRL/RWTE requires an upgrade to the Zeiss Xradia Versa system to support a classified, higher headquarters-directed project. This enhancement is necessary to accommodate X-raying larger test objects and achieve higher fidelity. To meet security requirements, all generated classified data will be managed on a dedicated, standalone computer system. Furthermore, a comprehensive service contract is required to maintain system calibration, ensure operational reliability, and guarantee data integrity.

- One (1) Flat Panel Extension to enable large-volume imaging and accommodate larger test items. This extension must extend multi-scale workflows, complete the RaaD detector architecture, and seamlessly integrate with the existing Zeiss Xradia Versa 730 platform.
- One (1) 40X Prime Objective Ultra-High Resolution assembly kit is required to generate data necessary for a detailed analysis of the object.
- One (1) XRM High-Performance Workstation is required to facilitate system operations and the generation of classified datasets. This dedicated workstation shall enable classified data to be generated and stored in isolation to prevent the entire Zeiss Xradia Versa system from becoming classified. Minimum specifications shall include professional-grade 3D Graphics Processing Unit (GPU), a dual core processor, and, and a 1TB M.2 SSD boot drive.
- Software to support gathering classified data.
- Installation and operator training on the new components and software.
- A one (1) year service agreement to ensure the system operates within normal limits and the data generated is reliable. The service agreement should provide for two preventative maintenance inspections during the year and emergency maintenance support during the year.

III. Description of supplies/services required to meet agency needs (RFO 6.104-1(a)(3)):

The Zeiss Xradia Versa is a high-resolution 3D X-ray microscope engineered for non-destructive, submicron-level imaging of materials and components. The current project introduces requirements for object scale and analytical detail that exceed the system's baseline configuration. However, Subject Matter Experts (SMEs) have determined that with the proposed upgrades and dedicated maintenance support, the Zeiss Xradia is fully capable of meeting these new mission parameters.

IV. Statutory Authority Permitting Other Than Full and Open Competition (RFO 6.104-1(a)(4)):

10 U.S.C. 3204(a)(1), Only one responsible source and no other supplies or services will satisfy agency requirements.

V. Rationale for Use of Authority (RFO 6.104-1(a)(5)):

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The nature of this acquisition requires the integration of proprietary hardware and software to upgrade the Government's closed-architecture Zeiss Xradia Versa microscopy system. Comprehensive market research, encompassing SAM.gov and open-source queries, direct vendor engagements, and operator capability assessments, conclusively determined that the manufacturer, Carl Zeiss Microscopy, LLC, is the only responsible source possessing the unique qualifications necessary to perform this work. Zeiss retains exclusive ownership of the proprietary technical data, closed-source software, and factory-trained expertise required to seamlessly install the new components and execute continued service support. Because utilizing unauthorized third-party vendors or non-OEM parts would compromise system calibration and risk catastrophic equipment failure, Carl Zeiss Microscopy is the only company capable of delivering the required upgraded capability and ensuring reliable system performance.

VI. Integrated Market Analysis and Efforts to Solicit Competition (RFO 6.104-1(a)(6), (8), and (10)):

In accordance with RFO Part 10, AFRL/RWTE conducted market research through internet searches and outreach through engagement with industry and yielded one result: Carl Zeiss Microscopy, LLC. Carl Zeiss Microscopy, LLC is the only responsible vendor capable of providing the necessary upgrades and repairs, in addition to providing maintenance services, of products manufactured by Carl Zeiss Microscopy, LLC. Market research confirmed that there are currently no small business set aside opportunities for these services, and they are not available through GSA or AbilityOne. Given that only the manufacturer, Carl Zeiss Microscopy, LLC, can meet the requirements, minimal additional market research was conducted at this time. Carl Zeiss Microscopy, LLC was directly contacted, and they provided a quote along with a sole-source letter confirming they are the sole source provider to fulfill the requirement. PZLEQ also posted an Intent to Sole Source (IASS) on SAM.gov, providing opportunity for capable vendors to respond. No responses were received.

VII. Determination of Fair and Reasonable Cost (RFO 6.104-1(a)(7)):

The Contracting Officer is responsible for evaluating, determining, and documenting the anticipated contract cost/price is fair and reasonable in accordance with RFO Subpart 15.4, Contract Pricing.

VIII. Any Other Facts Supporting the Justification (RFO 6.104-1(a)(9)):

The requested upgrade to the proprietary Zeiss Xradia Versa system is critical for a classified, Higher Headquarters-directed project, which includes a dedicated XRM workstation to isolate classified datasets and prevent the baseline microscopy equipment from becoming classified. Subject Matter Experts confirm that utilizing non-OEM components or unauthorized vendors on this closed-architecture system introduces unacceptable risks, including compromised calibration, degraded data fidelity, and catastrophic equipment failure.

IX. Actions to Overcome Barriers to Competition (RFO 6.104-1(a)(11)):

Market research confirms that Carl Zeiss Microscopy, LLC is the only responsible source possessing the proprietary technical data, specialized software, and authorized expertise required to perform this work. Consequently, there are no practical actions the Government can take to overcome these proprietary barriers and foster competition for this specific, immediate requirement. For any subsequent actions, AFRL/RWTE will continuously monitor and assess if market conditions have changed by looking for companies able to integrate equipment upgrades on the Zeiss Xradia Versa and maintain the system. If another company appears to have the capability to service the equipment, AFRL/RWTE will contact them.